

First Congregational Church of Los Angeles
Fall Series 2
Painting the Stars ~ Toward Healing the Rift
13 September 2026

COMMUNION

Preaching: LVF

Worship Leading: ML and JPC

Organ Prelude-Concert

Dr. Christoph Bull, *Organist-in-Residence*

Chiming of the Hour

[to center chancel]

Welcome

Words of Gathering

Please stand now, in body or in spirit, for our Hymn of Gathering

[Choir mics on for hymn leaders]

***Hymn Of Gathering**

[... center chancel]

Prayer of Awareness

[All turn towards choir]

Introit

[to lectern]

***The Lord's Prayer**

Let us pray together this Lord's Prayer, adapted by enfleshed...

[All turn towards altar]

***Gloria Deo**

Glory be to God, and to the Christ and to the Holy Ghost,
As it was in the beginning, is now and ever shall be.
World without end, Amen, Amen.

[center chancel]

***Passing of the Peace**

This morning, may the peace of God be with you.
And also with you!

You are invited to share this ancient greeting with a bow

Please be seated

[Jay to lectern]

Reading from Our Religious Tradition *from 1 Corinthians 15.58*

JPC

Therefore, my siblings, remain strong. Let nothing move you from resistance. Keep giving yourselves fully to God and know you do not labor in vain. Your stories shared are not in vain. Your solidarity is not in vain. Your proclamation is not in vain. Your protests are not in vain. Your phone calls are not in vain. Your survival is not in vain. Your hope is not in vain. Your care for one another is not in vain. Those in power come and go but the Spirit of Life is eternal. She takes all our offerings shared for Love's sake and multiplies them. Look not to thrones of power for the fruit of your labor. Is a single sister encouraged because you shared your story? Is a single brother committing to deepen his commitment to challenging toxic masculinity? Is a single nonbinary beloved encouraged by your protests in the street? The power of God, the ultimate power-with, makes a mockery of patriarchy, makes queer and transphobia bend low, makes white supremacy kiss the feet of justice, makes every spirit of destruction tremble at the sound of collective voices rising. Tend to your pain but do not let them convince you that your work is in vain. Every act of resistance in the directions of Love and Justice shall bring forth Life.

This is the witness of the ancients...

Thanks be to God!

[Christoph transition ... to center chancel]

Prayers with the People

Invitation to Silence and Prayer

[2 minutes of silence, then Emma transition out of silence]

Prayer of Our Hearts

[Christoph transition for Choir]

Meditation Anthem

[Christoph transition Laura to pulpit]

Sermon

Toward Healing the Rift

LVF

[Christoph transition as Laura & Jay go behind communion table]

The Eucharist and Blessings

Words of Invitation and Remembrance

You are welcome at this table if you have a little faith, a lot of faith, absolutely no faith, or are of another faith. This is the Table of the Christ, and the welcome is wide!

Sharing of the Bread and the Cup

At this table we celebrate all the diverse ways we have been created. Everyone is invited to share in this feast. This morning we will receive communion with gluten free wafers and grape juice. You are invited to come forward to receive these gifts and then light a candle to signify the prayers of your heart on this day. As we share this time, we remember that this is the bread of new life and the cup of hope, given in love for each of us.

[... to lectern]

Invitation to Generosity

Offertory

[All turn towards altar]

***Doxology**

From all that dwell below the skies,
let the Creator's praise arise!

Alleluia! Alleluia!

Your name shall sound and praises soar
till suns shall rise and set no more.

Alleluia! Alleluia!

Alleluia! Alleluia! Alleluia!

[adapt/Isaac Watts, 1719]

[Megan to lectern]

***Prayer of Offering**

Please be seated

[Michael and Laura center chancel]

Life at First Church

ML

Words of Blessing

LVF

Choral Response

[Choir mics on for hymn leaders]

***Hymn for the Journey**

[Michael center chancel]

Postlude

Dr. Christoph Bull, *Organist-in-Residence*

Inside The Music